Ryan Brubeck

Independent Security Researcher | AI & MCP Security

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PROFILE

Independent security researcher building a paid audit practice for AI infrastructure, MCP servers, and agent tooling. Focuses on authentication and authorization, tool trust boundaries, sandbox isolation, and sensitive-data handling. Experienced in coordinated disclosure, customer-facing software, and daily business operations.

SECURITY RESEARCH HIGHLIGHTS

- **57 externally validated findings** in a conservative evidence-gated ledger. Severity is recorded per finding; ledger severity categories are not combined into a single High/Critical headline. **18 directly attributable public records** across advisories, security bulletins, releases, and maintainer-confirmed issues. Not all validated findings are public.
- **AWS:** Publicly credited for PostgreSQL MCP read-only enforcement bypass leading to OS command execution under specific elevated database-role prerequisites. AWS rates it Important; GitHub advisory rates it Critical. AWS-2026-104 / GHSA.
- **IBM MCP Context Forge:** Credited for a RestrictedPython sandbox escape in `python_sandbox_server`, rated Critical for HTTP and High for stdio; regression test added in the subsequent release. Advisory / release diff. Also credited for an SSRF report; the advisory update withdraws the REST-path claim and notes Gateway/A2A paths were source-evident but not runtime-validated in that update. Advisory.
- Additional public work includes security findings affecting the MCP Python and Ruby SDKs, SigNoz, Obot, Zigbee2MQTT MCP, MCP SSH Tool, Repomix, Heimdall MCP, DeepCode, MariaDB MCP, Termux MCP, mcp-shell, and x64dbg MCP. Evidence links.

RESEARCH & AUDIT PRACTICE

Independent Security Researcher | 2026-Present

- Trace source from entry points through trust boundaries; connect missing controls to concrete user, data, and system impact.
- Develop safe local reproductions, negative controls, and patch checks; document root cause, deployment assumptions, severity rationale, and remediation.
- Coordinate reports with vendor security teams and open-source maintainers, including AWS Security, MSRC, and IBM project maintainers.
- Develop scoped paid audits for AI/MCP infrastructure with evidence-backed findings, remediation guidance, and fix verification.

BUILDING & OPERATIONS EXPERIENCE

Founder & Technical Lead, DreamSiteBuilders / TurfRank | 2025-Present

- Shipped 15+ production websites and customer-facing systems for local businesses; built TurfRank as an audit API/product for business review, search, trust, lead, and conversion checks.
- Built AI-assisted workflows for research, implementation, QA, reporting, and customer handoff, with human review of external actions.

Department Manager & Person-in-Charge, Albertsons / Acme Markets | Nov 2022-Present

- Managed storewide operations and urgent issues; trained 30+ employees and reduced shrink by 12% using operating reports, purchasing data, and process improvements.

TECHNICAL FOCUS & EDUCATION

Security: Authentication/authorization, SSRF, injection, sandbox escape, unsafe execution, file/path traversal, sensitive-data exposure, and deployment configuration.
Tools: Python, Bash, SQL, JavaScript/TypeScript, Linux, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub disclosure workflows, MCP, and browser automation.
Education: Rowan University, B.A. Economics, 2023. Founder, Blockchain Studies Club.